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AAPI adults' faith in GOP is fading

As midterms near, poll finds the community is more disillusioned with President Trump.

By Terry Tang, Nancy Jiang and Linley Sanders

WASHINGTON — Asian Americans, Native Hawaiians and Pacific Islander adults have become more disillusioned with President Trump and Republicans as the Nov. 3 midterm elections approach, according to a new AP-NORC/AAPI Data poll, giving Democrats a substantial edge on major issues such as the economy and healthcare.

The survey, which was conducted Sept. 8-15 by AAPI Data and the Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research, reveals that Trump's standing on the economy has fallen among AAPI adults over the course of his second term.

About one-quarter of AAPI adults approve of the way Trump is handling his job as president overall. Only about 2 in 10 approve of his performance on the economy, which the vast majority of AAPI adults see as one of the most important issues for the upcoming election.

But although AAPI adults trust Democrats more than Republicans on a wide range of issues, views of the Democratic Party itself are still split.

Rebecca Larocco, a 45-year-old Korean American in Corning, Iowa, voted for Trump in 2016 and is leaning Republican in the midterm elections. She approves of his immigration policies but is unsure about Trump's handling of the economy as the Iran war continues to compound gas prices.

"Where I'm at, it's went up almost $1.50" a gallon, she said. "I didn't expect to go into war at all; that has been definitely unexpected. ... I'm just hoping they'll do what they're saying and get our economy back on track, get

[See **Poll,** A7]



Apu Gomes AFP/Getty Images



Allen J. Schaben Los Angeles Times

FIREFIGHTERS, top, battle the Norte fire in San Juan Capistrano last week. Above, storm-driven swells crash into Capistrano Beach last month.

Fire, high surf in O.C. warn of what's ahead

More areas may face twin dangers this winter

By Hannah Fry and Noah Haggerty

Few cities in California last week felt the full brunt of the climate crisis more than the small coastal town of San Clemente.

The beach city at the southern end of Orange County for months has been dealing with widespread coastal erosion from El Niño-related Pacific storms that has threatened a crucial rail line and reshaped swaths of its beaches.

Then, as the waves were still pounding, a fire broke out in the city's bushy foothills Friday, quickly burning toward hillside neighborhoods and destroying homes in nearby San Juan Capistrano.

San Clemente's challenges demonstrate what more of California will probably face as the twin dangers of fire and coastal erosion converge this winter. Southern California is just entering its traditional fire season, and forecasters are predicting more coastal flooding and erosion from what is expected to be a severe El Niño winter.

"We're in a crisis," said Cameron Cosgrove, a 14-year San Clemente resident and a planning commissioner. "Our beaches are eroding and our wildfire risk is very high, especially during Santa Ana wind conditions. These are scary times and they require us to respond."

San Clemente is a quintessential California beach town with bluff-top enclaves offering panoramic views of the Pacific Ocean and famed beaches boasting some of the best surf breaks in the country. The waves are so epic in the "Spanish Village by the Sea" that it beat out all other California beach cities to host the surfing competition in the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

But the factors that make it such a desirable place to live and play also bring immense risks for destruction — sometimes simultaneously.

On Monday, firefighters were working to wash streaks of pink fire retardant off

[See **San Clemente,** A14]

Feds charge 28 in state accused of voter fraud

Officials arrest ll said to be noncitizens. Past claims were found to be exaggerated.

By Kevin Rector and Brittny Mejia

Federal authorities have charged 28 people from across California with illegally registering to vote or casting ballots in federal elections despite not being U.S. citizens — again escalating an election battle between the state and the Trump administration just weeks before the Nov. 3 midterms.

Authorities said that 11 of the 28 were arrested as of Monday morning and that the others "will be in custody in the near future." Some of the 28, all of whom are lawful U.S. permanent residents, are charged with lying about registering or voting on their naturalization paperwork, officials said; 21 of them are suspected of casting votes, some in multiple elections. None are undocumented immigrants, a favorite target of President Trump and a group he has accused of infiltrating U.S. elections in the past.

Those charged represent a tiny fraction of the 20,000 "likely noncitizens" that the Justice Department alleged are on California rolls just last week, and an even tinier fraction of the more than 190,000 noncitizens the Trump administration alleged were on state rolls as recently as July.

State officials have previously warned, along with independent elections experts, that the Trump administration has badly overstated voter fraud claims in other states. In Nevada, for example, officials recently found that all 185 people the Justice Department flagged as potential noncitizens were in fact citizens. The administration has repeatedly revised downward its estimate for how many "likely noncitizens" are on California's rolls.

Acting Deputy Atty. Gen. Trent McCotter cast the arrests during a Monday news conference as proof that California voter rolls are corrupted and need to be purged to prevent noncitizens from negating the legitimate votes of U.S. citizens, and that California officials who have rebuffed recent Trump administration efforts to purge the state's

[See **Arrests,** A6]

France on edge as curfews imposed

Parts of Paris are shut down because of rioting, looting. Police are overwhelmed.

By Michael Finnegan

PARIS — Two large sections of central Paris were shut down in a curfew Monday night as France was reeling from a weekend of nationwide rioting and looting that left much of the country stupefied by the scarcity of police in some of the hardest-hit neighborhoods.

Grocery stores, clothing shops, cafes, health clinics and public buildings were ransacked in Paris, Marseille, Bordeaux and other cities. Overwhelmed police forces often failed to intervene as thousands of vandals, many wearing masks and caps that hid their faces, shattered storefront windows and walked off with merchandise.

Crowds of young adults set cars, electric bikes and trash cans on fire. A patchwork of blazing barricades blocked traffic on many Paris streets and shrouded nearby buildings in black smoke.

What began last week with peaceful protests by high school students demanding better conditions in schools beset by overcrowding and decrepit facilities has morphed into roiling protests nationwide denouncing rising living costs and inequities in French society.

More than 500,000 people took to the streets Saturday and although most marched peacefully, others rampaged and began looting. The violence has left many in France with a sense that their nation was unraveling with a deeply unpopular president struggling to manage a growing debt crisis amid extreme social and po-

[See **France,** A3]

Unrest spreads through Europe

Protesters in several countries rally over inflation, housing and school funding. **WORLD, A3**



Michael Owen Baker For The Times

A WHALE breaches near Anacapa Island in 2025 on a UC Santa Barbara trip to look into protected areas.

Tribes take lead in marine protection

State's 'underwater parks' have their critics, namely the fishing industry.

By Lila Seidman

California has designated its first tribal-championed marine protected areas, often described as underwater parks. Although environmentalists celebrate the historic move, commercial fishers warn they will lose access to key waters.

The California Fish and Game Commission voted last week to create two roughly 9-square-mile State Marine Conservation Areas near Carpinteria and around Central California's Point Sal. Those efforts were co-led by the Santa Ynez Band of Chumash Indians and the Northern Chumash Tribal Council, respectively. Both areas will allow hook-and-line fishing from the shore but prohibit commercial fishing and sportfishing from a boat.

The marine conservation area near Point Sal encompasses kelp forests and what's known as Lion Rock, a haven for sea lions, seals and migratory birds, said Violet Sage Walker, chair of

[See **Protection,** A10]

Climate change curbs Santa Anas

Milder wind events are diminishing, but fire threat is not, UCLA study finds.

By Noah Haggerty

Southern California's specter of ruinous wildfire returned over the weekend with the first Santa Ana winds of the season, fueling fires in San Clemente and Malibu.

The Santa Anas, however, are becoming a bit less frequent — a consequence, ironically, of climate change.

Scientists have projected that by 2100, human greenhouse gas pollution will cut back the number of days these winds blow. Now, a research team led by UCLA scientists has found it's already happening.

The Santa Anas are driven in part by temperature differences between the cool deserts in Utah and Nevada and the warm California coast. With climate change warming the desert more than the ocean, there are fewer weak and moderate Santa Ana wind events, but this is unlikely to diminish the intensity of extreme wind-driven fires that pose a major threat to Southern California communities, according to their paper in the American Geophysical Union journal Earth's Future.

There is intense interest in the Santa Anas in Southern California. It's these winds that turn routine fires into blazes capable of jumping past firefighters' defenses and ripping through communities faster than residents can drive. They keep residents up at night as they rattle windows and wail through canyons. They activate armies of volunteers along the coast to catch arsonists and address careless behavior. They can even convince Topanga Elementary School to move classes out of the mountains to keep kids out of harm's way.

That global warming is diminishing them might sound counterintuitive — climate change, after all, is worsening much of the world's extreme weather. Yet it's true. Unfortunately, the lessening is not enough to protect us from devastating fires: Now, it's erasing 1 in every 200 wind events. By the end of the century, it will snuff out 1 of every 10 or 20, and only the milder ones.

"That's not going to save you much," said Tom Delworth, senior scientist at the

[See **Santa Anas,** A14]



Sherman Austin

OUTRAGE IN LONG BEACH

Members of the community are demanding answers after the violent detention of a former city employee by ICE agents. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

A blow to Saudi investment event

The kingdom's flagship conference is postponed because of attacks by Yemen's Houthi rebels. **BUSINESS, A9**

Lakers waive former top pick

Knecht, taken in the 2024 draft, had tried to work his way back into rotation. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather
Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 81/64. **B6**

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